

Lab 30 Worksheet — Windows Command Line — Navigation, Files and Copy Operations

Name: ____ Date: ____

Exam objective: Use the Windows command line for navigation, file management and resilient copy operations, choosing correctly between copy, xcopy and robocopy (Core 2 objective 1.2).

Record as you go

Step	What you did	What you observed
1	Open Command Prompt as administrator and confirm your starting location and the commands available.	
2	Practise navigation: move between directories, move up one level, and return to the drive root.	
3	List directory contents with the switches that matter: all files including hidden, and a recursive listing.	
4	Create a directory structure for the exercise and confirm it exists.	
5	Create test files with content so the copy operations have something real to move.	
6	Use copy for a single file and record its limitation — it copies files only and cannot handle directory trees.	
7	Use xcopy with the switches for subdirectories including empty ones, and record that it handles trees but cannot resume.	
8	Use robocopy to mirror the source to the destination, which is the correct tool for a real migration.	
9	Read the robocopy log and record the files copied, skipped and failed, and the total bytes	

Step	What you did	What you observed
	transferred.	
10	Record why robocopy is the right choice for migrations: it retries failed files, resumes interrupted transfers, preserves attributes and timestamps, and logs everything.	
11	Warn on the /MIR switch: it makes the destination identical to the source, which means it deletes files in the destination that are not in the source. Verify the destination before every mirror.	
12	Verify the migration by comparing both directories, then clean up the exercise files.	

Verification

Success criterion: Every command executes without error, the robocopy log confirms the expected file count copied, your reference sheet states the specific limitation of copy and xcopy that robocopy overcomes, and the /MIR deletion warning is recorded.

- I completed every step in the lab.
- My result meets the success criterion above.
- I recorded my evidence (screenshots, output, completed tables).

Reflection

What surprised you in this lab?

Where would you apply this on the job?

What do you still need to revise before the exam?
